

**U.S. Department of Education - EDCAPS
G5-Technical Review Form (New)**

Status: Submitted

Last Updated: 05/07/2022 10:13 PM

Technical Review Coversheet

Applicant: Purdue University (S206A220038)

Reader #1: *****

	Points Possible	Points Scored
Questions		
Selection Criteria		
Need for Project		
1. Need for Project	5	5
Quality of Project Design		
1. Project Design	30	25
Quality of the Management Plan		
1. Management Plan	20	16
Quality of Project Services		
1. Project Services	30	30
Quality of Personnel		
1. Project Personnel	5	4
Adequacy of Resources		
1. Adequacy of Resources	10	9
Sub Total	100	89
Priority Questions		
Competitive Preference Priority		
Competitive Preference Priority 1		
1. CPP 1	5	5
Competitive Preference Priority 2		
1. CPP 2	5	5
Competitive Preference Priority 3		
1. CPP 3	5	5
Sub Total	15	15
Application Requirements		
4644(b) and (c) of the ESEA		
1. Requirement 1	0	0
2. Requirement 2	0	0
3. Requirement 3	0	0
Sub Total	0	0
Total	115	104

Technical Review Form

Panel #5 - FY22 Javits - 5: 84.206A

Reader #1: *****

Applicant: Purdue University (S206A220038)

Questions

Selection Criteria - Need for Project

1. (a) Need for Project (up to 5 points).

The Secretary considers the need for the proposed project. In determining the need for the proposed project, the Secretary considers the extent to which specific gaps or weaknesses in services, infrastructure, or opportunities have been identified and will be addressed by the proposed project, including the nature and magnitude of those gaps or weaknesses.

Strengths:

The proposed project is focused on shifting the long-standing practice of cognitive development as the central assumption of gifted education and academic talent development, toward affective and metacognitive strengths promoted through content area curricula, with the goal of reducing the representation gap of students receiving gifted education services (e17) -- specifically, those who are racially and ethnically diverse students, those with disabilities, and those from lower socioeconomic environments (e13). The proposed project's approach integrates instruction and assessment for all students, whereby classroom teachers can observe students using and applying self-regulation, perseverance, optimism, and metacognitive skills (e18).

Weaknesses:

No weaknesses noted.

Reader's Score: 5

Selection Criteria - Quality of Project Design

1. (b) Quality of the Project Design (up to 30 points).

The Secretary considers the quality of the design of the proposed project. In determining the quality of the design of the proposed project, the Secretary considers the following factors:

- (1) The extent to which the goals, objectives, and outcomes to be achieved by the proposed project are clearly specified and measurable;
- (2) The extent to which the design of the proposed project is appropriate to, and will successfully address, the needs of the target population or other identified needs;
- (3) The extent to which the proposed project is designed to build capacity and yield results that will extend beyond the period of Federal financial assistance;
- (4) The extent to which the design of the proposed project reflects up-to-date knowledge from research and effective practice;

(5) The extent to which the proposed project is supported by promising evidence; and

(6) The extent to which performance feedback and continuous improvement are integral to the design of the proposed project.

Strengths:

(1) The proposal contains a list of project goals as well as corresponding objectives and target outcomes that are measurable (e26-29, e100-104). The goals include implementing and evaluating the effectiveness of the BEM-e model in four schools; designing and delivering training for educators in the use of the BEM-e to identify underrepresented students; identifying and providing gifted education services using positive psychology traits in a dynamic assessment approach; and facilitate nationwide adoption of the models through dissemination of research findings.

(3) All of the training materials, psychology modules, instruments, and scoring guides will be accessible online (e30) and accessible for any middle school with a low cost of investment (e30). Likewise, all identification methods can be used with all middle school students. Collectively, the accessibility and high utility of the materials make it feasible and appealing to continue to build capacity within schools and extend beyond the funding period.

(4) The proposal identifies information from research and effective practice that is used as the framework for each component of the project design (e30-32), indicating alignment of the proposed project to the needs described in the collective literature and the likelihood of a positive impact on students.

(5) The project builds on evidence in favor of metacognitive skill development, affective support, psychosocial coaching, and positive psychology interventions (e32-36). For each of these four components, evidence from research is provided to support the decision for inclusion of the component in the proposed project.

(6) The proposed project has an analytic plan that will be carried out annually to evaluate project progress (e38). The analytic plan incorporates both a regression discontinuity evaluation and a single-case-based evaluation. Likewise, each school's change in odds of selection for each school's talent development program by demographic group will be calculated annually. Each year, the evaluation will be used to inform any changes needed to the identification or intervention method. This plan indicates a commitment to continuous improvement based on systematic analysis of the data.

Weaknesses:

(2) While the proposal is described as a five-phase plan (e22-25), it is not clear how the timeline (e41-42) would look in reference to a single student. For example, it is not clear if a student would be screened, identified as a student of interest, receive instruction using the five modules, reevaluated, and potentially included in gifted education services at the school all in a single school year or if this process would take multiple years.

Reader's Score: 25

Selection Criteria - Quality of the Management Plan

1. (c) Quality of the Management Plan (up to 20 points).

The Secretary considers the quality of the management plan for the proposed project. In determining the quality of the management plan for the proposed project, the Secretary considers the following factors:

(1) The adequacy of the management plan to achieve the objectives of the proposed project on-time and within budget, including clearly defined responsibilities, timelines, and milestones for accomplishing project tasks;

(2) The adequacy of procedures for ensuring feedback and continuous improvement in the operation of the proposed project; and

(3) The extent to which the time commitments of the project director and principal investigator and other key project personnel are appropriate and adequate to meet the objectives of the proposed project.

Strengths:

(2) An annual evaluation is built into the management plan (e42). Additionally, an advisory board, consisting of a group of external experts with diverse experience, will meet annually with the project team and provide regular feedback, as needed, to help improve development and implementation of the modules, professional development for teachers, and overall evaluation of project goals and objectives (e42-43). Collectively, these procedures will help support continuous improvement.

(3) The time commitment of the Principal Investigator, co-PIs and other key personnel (e43, 93-94) seem reasonable given the description of their expected duties.

Weaknesses:

(1) The proposal includes a table (e42) outlining project goals, objectives, activities, key personnel, and a timeline (e26) as well as a flowchart (e65-66) that presents a summary of each phase of the project. It is not clear which phases occur in which of the five funding years and whether some phases span multiple years or overlap, making it difficult to determine adequacy of the management plan to achieve the objectives of the proposed project on time.

Reader's Score: 16

Selection Criteria - Quality of Project Services

1. (d) Quality of the Project Services (up to 30 points).

The Secretary considers the quality of the services to be provided by the proposed project.

(1) In determining the quality of the services to be provided by the proposed project, the Secretary considers the quality and sufficiency of strategies for ensuring equal access and treatment for eligible project participants who are members of groups that have traditionally been underrepresented based on race, color, national origin, gender, age, or disability.

(2) In addition, the Secretary considers the likely impact of the services to be provided by the proposed project on the intended recipients of those services.

Strengths:

(1) The project has three, overarching aspects that promote equal access for all eligible project participants. The identification tools, by nature, will aid in identifying underrepresented students. Universal screening will be used with all students in the participating grades at each school. Targeted, affective development supports will be provided to traditionally underrepresented students so that they may be successful (e43). The triangulation of these components is a noted strength in ensuring equal access for all students.

(2) The proposed project's services would impact students who otherwise might not have ever been identified as gifted. Teachers would be trained to work with those students (and all students in their classroom) to provide appropriate opportunities that would complement their strengths e43). Likewise, the body of research from which the proposed work is

based indicates the students who should be most impacted (those who are underrepresented in gifted education) will be impacted positively.

Weaknesses:

No weaknesses noted.

Reader's Score: 30

Selection Criteria - Quality of Personnel

1. (e) Quality of Personnel (up to 5 points).

The Secretary considers the quality of the personnel who will carry out the proposed project.

(1) In determining the quality of the project personnel, the Secretary considers the extent to which the applicant encourages applications for employment from persons who are members of groups that have traditionally been underrepresented based on race, color, national origin, gender, age, or disability.

(2) In addition, the Secretary considers the following factors–

(i) The qualifications, including relevant training and experience, of the project director or principal investigator; and

(ii) The qualifications, including relevant training and experience, of key project personnel.

Strengths:

(2) The project director, co-PI, and other key personnel serve in current roles highly aligned with the work of the proposed project and have previous experience related to work in the proposed project.

Weaknesses:

(1) One avenue through which potential project personnel would be recruited is via campus entities that specifically provide support services for underrepresented populations (e8) – e.g. Purdue's Cultural and Resource Centers (the Black Cultural Center, Latino Cultural Center, the LGBTQ Center, and Native American Educational Center). This is a passive approach, and there is no mention of recruitment or hiring practices as they relate to persons who are members of groups that have traditionally been underrepresented based on race, color, national origin, gender, age, or disability.

Reader's Score: 4

Selection Criteria - Adequacy of Resources

1. (f) Adequacy of Resources (up to 10 points).

The Secretary considers the adequacy of resources for the proposed project. In determining the adequacy of resources for the proposed project, the Secretary considers one or more of the following factors:

(1) The extent to which the budget is adequate to support the proposed project;

(2) The extent to which the costs are reasonable in relation to the objectives, design, and potential significance of the proposed project; and

(3) The extent to which the costs are reasonable in relation to the number of persons to be served and to the anticipated results and benefits.

Strengths:

The project is targeting four middle schools and at least one grade level per school. All students in the grade level would be screened and their data analyzed by project personnel. The total project budget narrative (e93-96) includes salary for personnel (\$1,141,404), about half of the total budget. Given the time commitment needed from the project leadership and other key personnel, as well their level of accomplishment and expertise, having 50% of the budget allocated to personnel is understandable. Likewise, having half of the project budget allocated to providing participating teachers with training stipends, honorariums for the advisory panel, data transcribing, travel, etc. also appears reasonable.

Weaknesses:

The purpose of attending conferences is not noted, therefore the cost for this expense cannot be justified (e95).

Reader's Score: 9

Priority Questions

Competitive Preference Priority - Competitive Preference Priority 1

- 1. (1) Competitive Preference Priority 1--Training Personnel in the Identification and Education of Gifted and Talented Students Who are Children with Disabilities. (up to 5 points)**

Projects that include providing training to personnel in schools served under the project to assist such personnel in identifying and educating gifted and talented students who are children with disabilities. Such training may include, but is not limited to, workshops or programs that teach effective instructional and communication techniques, classroom practices and culture, and other strategies that support the social, emotional, developmental and academic needs of gifted and talented students who are children with disabilities.

Strengths:

This project intends to address the representation gap in gifted education for racially and ethnically diverse students, those with disabilities, and those from lower socioeconomic environments by using a combination of static and dynamic assessment procedures centered around positive psychology modules implemented by trained teachers with middle school students (e13). Given the focus on classroom instruction around the positive psychology modules, teachers will be equipped to serve underserved students in the context of this project and possibly beyond the funding years.

Weaknesses:

No weaknesses noted.

Reader's Score: 5

Competitive Preference Priority - Competitive Preference Priority 2

- 1. (2) Competitive Preference Priority 2--Identification of, and Provision of Services to, Gifted and Talented Students Who are Children with Disabilities. (up to 5 points)**

Projects that include developing new information that assists schools in the identification of, and provision of services to, gifted and talented students who are children with disabilities who may not be identified through traditional assessment methods.

Strengths:

To reduce the representation gap of students receiving gifted education services, the proposed project is focused on shifting the long-standing practice of cognitive development as the central assumption of gifted education and academic talent development, toward affective and metacognitive strengths promoted through content area curricula (e17). The project approach integrates instruction and assessment for all students, where classroom teachers can observe students using and applying self-regulation, perseverance, optimism, and metacognitive skills (e18).

Weaknesses:

No weaknesses noted.

Reader's Score: 5

Competitive Preference Priority - Competitive Preference Priority 3

1. (3) Competitive Preference Priority 3--Promoting Equity in Student Access to Educational Resources and Opportunities. (up to 5 points)

Projects designed to promote educational equity and adequacy in resources and opportunity for underserved students—

(1) In one or more of the following educational settings:

- (i) Middle school.**
- (ii) Elementary school.***
- (iii) High school.**
- (iv) Career and technical education programs.**
- (v) Out-of-school-time settings;**

(2) That examine the sources of inequity and inadequacy and implement responses, and that may include one or more of the following:

(i) Rigorous, engaging, and well-rounded (e.g., that include music and the arts) approaches to learning that are inclusive with regard to race, ethnicity, culture, language, and disability status and prepare students for college, career, and civic life, including one or more of the following:

(A) Student-centered learning models that may leverage technology to address learner variability (e.g., universal design for learning, K-12 competency-based education, project-based learning, or hybrid/blended learning) and provide high-quality learning content, applications, or tools.

(B) Middle school courses or projects that prepare students to participate in advanced coursework in high school.

(C) Advanced courses and programs, including dual enrollment and early college programs.

(D) Project-based and experiential learning, including service and work-based learning.

(E) High-quality career and technical education courses, pathways, and industry-recognized credentials that are integrated into the curriculum.

(F) Science, technology, engineering, and mathematics (STEM), including computer science coursework.

(ii) Increasing the number and proportion of experienced, fully certified, in-field, and effective educators, and educators from traditionally underrepresented backgrounds or the communities they serve, to ensure that underserved students have educators from those backgrounds and communities and are not taught at disproportionately higher rates by uncertified, out-of-field, and novice teachers compared to their peers.**

***Note:** The Javits program supports gifted and talented programs and their students in elementary schools and secondary schools. In States in which elementary education includes preschool, preschool students may receive services through the Javits program.

****Note:** All strategies to increase racial diversity of educators must comply with applicable law, including Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964.

Strengths:

Using a comprehensive professional development program, educators of students in grades 6-8 will be trained in a model that integrates positive psychological knowledge and skills with techniques for implementing a collection of modules employing a dynamic assessment approach. Information and skills acquired in these training sessions have applicability to all students, with the emphasis remaining on identification of methods for students from underrepresented groups, specifically those with disabilities (e3).

Weaknesses:

No weaknesses noted.

Reader's Score: 5

Application Requirements - 4644(b) and (c) of the ESEA

1. (1) The proposed identification methods, as well as gifted and talented services, materials, and methods, can be adapted, if appropriate, for use by all students;

The only score that can be given is zero (0).

Met

Reader's Score: 0

2. (2) The proposed programs can be evaluated

The only score that can be given is zero (0).

Met

Reader's Score: 0

3. (3) The proposed project will provide for training of personnel in the identification and education of gifted and talented students and in the use, where appropriate, of gifted and talented services, materials, and methods for all students.

The only score that can be given is zero (0).

Met

Reader's Score: **0**

Status: Submitted

Last Updated: 05/07/2022 10:13 PM

Status: Submitted

Last Updated: 05/06/2022 09:52 PM

Technical Review Coversheet

Applicant: Purdue University (S206A220038)

Reader #2: *****

	Points Possible	Points Scored
Questions		
Selection Criteria		
Need for Project		
1. Need for Project	5	5
Quality of Project Design		
1. Project Design	30	27
Quality of the Management Plan		
1. Management Plan	20	17
Quality of Project Services		
1. Project Services	30	30
Quality of Personnel		
1. Project Personnel	5	3
Adequacy of Resources		
1. Adequacy of Resources	10	8
Sub Total	100	90
Priority Questions		
Competitive Preference Priority		
Competitive Preference Priority 1		
1. CPP 1	5	5
Competitive Preference Priority 2		
1. CPP 2	5	5
Competitive Preference Priority 3		
1. CPP 3	5	5
Sub Total	15	15
Application Requirements		
4644(b) and (c) of the ESEA		
1. Requirement 1	0	0
2. Requirement 2	0	0
3. Requirement 3	0	0
Sub Total	0	0
Total	115	105

Technical Review Form

Panel #5 - FY22 Javits - 5: 84.206A

Reader #2: *****

Applicant: Purdue University (S206A220038)

Questions

Selection Criteria - Need for Project

1. (a) Need for Project (up to 5 points).

The Secretary considers the need for the proposed project. In determining the need for the proposed project, the Secretary considers the extent to which specific gaps or weaknesses in services, infrastructure, or opportunities have been identified and will be addressed by the proposed project, including the nature and magnitude of those gaps or weaknesses.

Strengths:

The proposed project would reduce the representation gap of minority students in gifted education using cognition and metacognitive skills. Students with disabilities and economically challenged students are included to implement alternative identification approaches to decrease the underrepresentation of racially ethnically, economically, and ability diverse students living in rural locations (e17-18).

Weaknesses:

No weaknesses noted.

Reader's Score: 5

Selection Criteria - Quality of Project Design

1. (b) Quality of the Project Design (up to 30 points).

The Secretary considers the quality of the design of the proposed project. In determining the quality of the design of the proposed project, the Secretary considers the following factors:

- (1) The extent to which the goals, objectives, and outcomes to be achieved by the proposed project are clearly specified and measurable;
- (2) The extent to which the design of the proposed project is appropriate to, and will successfully address, the needs of the target population or other identified needs;
- (3) The extent to which the proposed project is designed to build capacity and yield results that will extend beyond the period of Federal financial assistance;
- (4) The extent to which the design of the proposed project reflects up-to-date knowledge from research and effective practice;
- (5) The extent to which the proposed project is supported by promising evidence; and
- (6) The extent to which performance feedback and continuous improvement are integral to the design of the proposed project.

Strengths:

- (1) The goals, objectives, and outcomes of the proposed project are measurable. The applicant included specific targets for the number of educators to participate in and complete training, the number of students to be assessed through universal screening, the percentage of students who will demonstrate growth in self-perception and engagement, and the percentage of educators whose knowledge will increase regarding the identification of traditionally underrepresented students in gifted education (26-27). BEM-e will be used as a model to identify students and promote nationwide use of the model.
- (2) The design of the project will address the needs of the target populations. The project is set up in strategic phases that span student screening, professional development, implementation of strategies, identification of students, as well as intervention and program services (e24-25).
- (3) The project can be extended beyond the project funding period because the training and scoring modules can be accessed online, and the project is easily adaptable for all middle school students (e30).
- (4) Current research supports the proposed project design to address cognitive functioning and the emotions associated with overcoming identification barriers. The need to broaden identification strategies is supported (e30) and aligned with literature.
- (5) Promising evidence supports the strategies that will be implemented through the proposed project. Use of dynamic assessments has shown that students may be identified for gifted programs when not identified via traditional tests. Affective support and psychosocial coaching have been successful for talent development (e34-35).
- (6) Annual evaluation will occur for the new identification method and the BEM-e intervention. The results will be used to make changes to the strategies as needed. Logistic regression models, comparison data, and annual interviews will be conducted with educators. Ongoing feedback will be shared during module tasks (e38-40).

Weaknesses:

- (2) The applicant does not specify which grade levels will be included for screening students at the middle school (e23).

Reader's Score: **27**

Selection Criteria - Quality of the Management Plan**1. (c) Quality of the Management Plan (up to 20 points).**

The Secretary considers the quality of the management plan for the proposed project. In determining the quality of the management plan for the proposed project, the Secretary considers the following factors:

- (1) The adequacy of the management plan to achieve the objectives of the proposed project on-time and within budget, including clearly defined responsibilities, timelines, and milestones for accomplishing project tasks;**
- (2) The adequacy of procedures for ensuring feedback and continuous improvement in the operation of the proposed project; and**
- (3) The extent to which the time commitments of the project director and principal investigator and other key project personnel are appropriate and adequate to meet the objectives of the proposed project.**

Strengths:

- (1) The applicant has shared a yearly plan to accomplish program goals which includes the lead person responsible for the components. Three times a year, the project leaders, who will meet monthly, will evaluate the project model, components, and procedures (e42).
- (2) Feedback will be provided through an advisory board to help improve module development and implementation of

assessments and online sessions for all participants (e42).

(3) The time commitments of one Co-PI (5% time and effort per academic year during the course of the project) a second Co-PI (2.5% effort during the academic year and 1 summer month each year of the project) and a third Co-PI (two summer weeks in each year of the project), and key personnel (1 summer month each year of the project), a post-doctoral student at 100%, and graduate assistants are shared to meet the objectives of the proposed project (e93).

Weaknesses:

The applicant shared a flowchart with phases that do not include specific information or a timeline for implementation to match the overall timeline for the proposed project. It is unclear when the components of the flowchart will be implemented throughout the project (e42).

Reader's Score: 17

Selection Criteria - Quality of Project Services

1. (d) Quality of the Project Services (up to 30 points).

The Secretary considers the quality of the services to be provided by the proposed project.

(1) In determining the quality of the services to be provided by the proposed project, the Secretary considers the quality and sufficiency of strategies for ensuring equal access and treatment for eligible project participants who are members of groups that have traditionally been underrepresented based on race, color, national origin, gender, age, or disability.

(2) In addition, the Secretary considers the likely impact of the services to be provided by the proposed project on the intended recipients of those services.

Strengths:

(1) Positive psychology, universal screening, and targeted affective development will be utilized to provide the necessary support for traditionally underrepresented students (e43).

(2) The proposed project has the potential to positively impact the affective development of proposed participants by increasing the number of traditionally underrepresented students for gifted and talented services, and improving the relationships, growth, and self-acceptance of all students (e43).

Weaknesses:

No weaknesses noted.

Reader's Score: 30

Selection Criteria - Quality of Personnel

1. (e) Quality of Personnel (up to 5 points).

The Secretary considers the quality of the personnel who will carry out the proposed project.

(1) In determining the quality of the project personnel, the Secretary considers the extent to which the applicant encourages applications for employment from persons who are members of groups that have traditionally been underrepresented based on race, color, national origin, gender, age, or disability.

(2) In addition, the Secretary considers the following factors–

(i) The qualifications, including relevant training and experience, of the project director or principal investigator; and

(ii) The qualifications, including relevant training and experience, of key project personnel.

Strengths:

(2i) The qualifications, training, and experience of the principal investigator are included in the proposed project. Expertise in gifted education, talent development, educational psychology, intervention, school counseling, research methodology, and graduate student supervision are shared. Normal university recruitment efforts will be implemented including position announcements that will be shared through the campus listserve (e8).

Weaknesses:

(1) The applicant does not indicate encouragement of applications for employment from persons who are members of groups that have traditionally been underrepresented, including the persons targeted to implement the proposed project.

(2ii) The qualifications, training, and experience of key project personnel are not included (budget narrative).

Reader's Score: 3

Selection Criteria - Adequacy of Resources

1. (f) Adequacy of Resources (up to 10 points).

The Secretary considers the adequacy of resources for the proposed project. In determining the adequacy of resources for the proposed project, the Secretary considers one or more of the following factors:

(1) The extent to which the budget is adequate to support the proposed project;

(2) The extent to which the costs are reasonable in relation to the objectives, design, and potential significance of the proposed project; and

(3) The extent to which the costs are reasonable in relation to the number of persons to be served and to the anticipated results and benefits.

Strengths:

(1) The budget is adequate to support the proposed project. Funds are allocated for each component of the project over the duration of the funding period.

Weaknesses:

(2) The costs are not reasonable in relation to the objectives, design, and significance of the proposed project. It is not clear how the funds for travel to the conference attendance relates to the project goals or if the applicant plans to present or disseminate project information at the conference (budget narrative).

(3) The applicant does not state the total number of participants to be served by the project.

Reader's Score: 8

Priority Questions**Competitive Preference Priority - Competitive Preference Priority 1**

1. (1) **Competitive Preference Priority 1--Training Personnel in the Identification and Education of Gifted and Talented Students Who are Children with Disabilities. (up to 5 points)**

Projects that include providing training to personnel in schools served under the project to assist such personnel in identifying and educating gifted and talented students who are children with disabilities. Such training may include, but is not limited to, workshops or programs that teach effective instructional and communication techniques, classroom practices and culture, and other strategies that support the social, emotional, developmental and academic needs of gifted and talented students who are children with disabilities.

Strengths:

The applicant plans to train personnel in the identification of gifted and talented students who have disabilities. Workshops and modules are scheduled to improve the educational experiences of 2e students (e13).

Weaknesses:

No weaknesses noted.

Reader's Score: 5

Competitive Preference Priority - Competitive Preference Priority 2

1. (2) **Competitive Preference Priority 2--Identification of, and Provision of Services to, Gifted and Talented Students Who are Children with Disabilities. (up to 5 points)**

Projects that include developing new information that assists schools in the identification of, and provision of services to, gifted and talented students who are children with disabilities who may not be identified through traditional assessment methods.

Strengths:

The proposed project indicates the need to offer an expansion of evaluation efforts of students from underrepresented groups because they are typically overlooked by the use of traditional assessments (e14).

Weaknesses:

No weaknesses noted.

Reader's Score: 5

Competitive Preference Priority - Competitive Preference Priority 3

1. (3) Competitive Preference Priority 3--Promoting Equity in Student Access to Educational Resources and Opportunities. (up to 5 points)

Projects designed to promote educational equity and adequacy in resources and opportunity for underserved students—

(1) In one or more of the following educational settings:

- (i) Middle school.**
- (ii) Elementary school.***
- (iii) High school.**
- (iv) Career and technical education programs.**
- (v) Out-of-school-time settings;**

(2) That examine the sources of inequity and inadequacy and implement responses, and that may include one or more of the following:

(i) Rigorous, engaging, and well-rounded (e.g., that include music and the arts) approaches to learning that are inclusive with regard to race, ethnicity, culture, language, and disability status and prepare students for college, career, and civic life, including one or more of the following:

(A) Student-centered learning models that may leverage technology to address learner variability (e.g., universal design for learning, K-12 competency-based education, project-based learning, or hybrid/blended learning) and provide high-quality learning content, applications, or tools.

(B) Middle school courses or projects that prepare students to participate in advanced coursework in high school.

(C) Advanced courses and programs, including dual enrollment and early college programs.

(D) Project-based and experiential learning, including service and work-based learning.

(E) High-quality career and technical education courses, pathways, and industry-recognized credentials that are integrated into the curriculum.

(F) Science, technology, engineering, and mathematics (STEM), including computer science coursework.

(ii) Increasing the number and proportion of experienced, fully certified, in-field, and effective educators, and educators from traditionally underrepresented backgrounds or the communities they serve, to ensure that underserved students have educators from those backgrounds and communities and are not taught at disproportionately higher rates by uncertified, out-of-field, and novice teachers compared to their peers.**

***Note: The Javits program supports gifted and talented programs and their students in elementary schools and secondary schools. In States in which elementary education includes preschool, preschool students may receive services through the Javits program.**

****Note: All strategies to increase racial diversity of educators must comply with applicable law, including Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964.**

Strengths:

(1) The applicant plans to promote the educational equity and adequacy in resources and opportunity for underserved students in middle school (e14).

(2i) Inequity and inadequacy in gifted education identification will be addressed by the proposed project. Considerations for inclusive practices to increase the identification of students from racial, cultural, linguistic, and those with disability status will be made to prepare students for college and career opportunities and success.

Weaknesses:

No weaknesses noted.

Reader's Score: 5

Application Requirements - 4644(b) and (c) of the ESEA

1. (1) The proposed identification methods, as well as gifted and talented services, materials, and methods, can be adapted, if appropriate, for use by all students;

The only score that can be given is zero (0).

Met

Reader's Score: 0

2. (2) The proposed programs can be evaluated

The only score that can be given is zero (0).

Met

Reader's Score: 0

3. (3) The proposed project will provide for training of personnel in the identification and education of gifted and talented students and in the use, where appropriate, of gifted and talented services, materials, and methods for all students.

The only score that can be given is zero (0).

Met

Reader's Score: 0

Status: Submitted

Last Updated: 05/06/2022 09:52 PM

Status: Submitted

Last Updated: 05/06/2022 06:54 PM

Technical Review Coversheet

Applicant: Purdue University (S206A220038)

Reader #3: *****

	Points Possible	Points Scored
Questions		
Selection Criteria		
Need for Project		
1. Need for Project	5	5
Quality of Project Design		
1. Project Design	30	28
Quality of the Management Plan		
1. Management Plan	20	16
Quality of Project Services		
1. Project Services	30	30
Quality of Personnel		
1. Project Personnel	5	4
Adequacy of Resources		
1. Adequacy of Resources	10	9
Sub Total	100	92
Priority Questions		
Competitive Preference Priority		
Competitive Preference Priority 1		
1. CPP 1	5	5
Competitive Preference Priority 2		
1. CPP 2	5	5
Competitive Preference Priority 3		
1. CPP 3	5	5
Sub Total	15	15
Application Requirements		
4644(b) and (c) of the ESEA		
1. Requirement 1	0	0
2. Requirement 2	0	0
3. Requirement 3	0	0
Sub Total	0	0
Total	115	107

Technical Review Form

Panel #5 - FY22 Javits - 5: 84.206A

Reader #3: *****

Applicant: Purdue University (S206A220038)

Questions

Selection Criteria - Need for Project

1. (a) Need for Project (up to 5 points).

The Secretary considers the need for the proposed project. In determining the need for the proposed project, the Secretary considers the extent to which specific gaps or weaknesses in services, infrastructure, or opportunities have been identified and will be addressed by the proposed project, including the nature and magnitude of those gaps or weaknesses.

Strengths:

Applicant provided a comprehensive and current review of the gaps associated with misidentification of G/T students from traditionally underserved populations. Current estimates cited indicate that students with disabilities are underrepresented by 75% (pg. e17). The primary issue is centered on the historical use of cognition as the main criterion. This project will shift the focus towards affective and metacognitive strengths for identifying G/T students. One of the foundational elements of the applicant's approach is to use the Bull's Eye Model for Affective Development (BEM) (pg. e18). This approach along with other identified measures (i.e. models) should substantially address the misidentification gap.

Weaknesses:

None noted

Reader's Score: 5

Selection Criteria - Quality of Project Design

1. (b) Quality of the Project Design (up to 30 points).

The Secretary considers the quality of the design of the proposed project. In determining the quality of the design of the proposed project, the Secretary considers the following factors:

- (1) The extent to which the goals, objectives, and outcomes to be achieved by the proposed project are clearly specified and measurable;
- (2) The extent to which the design of the proposed project is appropriate to, and will successfully address, the needs of the target population or other identified needs;
- (3) The extent to which the proposed project is designed to build capacity and yield results that will extend beyond the period of Federal financial assistance;
- (4) The extent to which the design of the proposed project reflects up-to-date knowledge from research and effective practice;
- (5) The extent to which the proposed project is supported by promising evidence; and
- (6) The extent to which performance feedback and continuous improvement are integral to the design of the proposed project.

Strengths:

Overall, the applicant has a well thought-out design using a conceptual framework that is a research-based theoretical perspective on affective development of students with gifts, talents, and creativity. The BEM is described in detail, and the applicant will employ five phases for implementation. Each of the five phases are appropriate, fully explained, and of high quality (pg. e22).

1. The applicant clearly articulates the project's four major goals, objectives, and outcomes as well as how they will be measured (pg. e26-28). For example, goal number 1, objective 1a is to select four middle schools in urban and rural communities that serve students who are traditionally underrepresented in gifted education. The outcome measure is that the sample selects schools with at least one-third of the student population from the identified underrepresented groups. This is a measurement that is specific and quantifiable based on district and state data.
2. The proposed project design is appropriate and will successfully address the needs of the target population. It is research-based, makes extensive use of proven models for better identification, and will provide the needed training for educators (pg. e28).
3. Capacity building is ensured as educators will be trained in the delivery of positive psychology instructional models. These instructional models will remain accessible online (pg. e30). The proposed identification methods can be used with all students. (pg. e30).
4. The applicant provides a strong literature foundation for what they are proposing. Specifically highlighted are those assessment procedures that are centered on non-cognitive measures. The literature is up-to-date and reflects the most current and available practices (pg. e31-32).
5. The applicant builds on promising evidence from four major lines of research: 1) dynamic assessment, 2) metacognitive skill development, 3) affective support and psychological coaching, and 4) positive psychological interventions (pg. e32-38). Each promising approach is thoroughly discussed and supported by multiple research citations. One strong feature is the identification of five, specific positive psychology interventions that will be used. These five are: 1) hope, 2) self-efficacy and self-perception, 3) goal valuation, 4) mindfulness, and 5) gratitude (pg. e34-38). These are highly relevant for the target population and should be of great benefit.
6. The applicant makes extensive use of multiple assessment approaches that will provide feedback to the project. Mentioned are a regression discontinuity evaluation measure for the new identification method and a single-case based evaluation of the BEM-e interventions (pg. e38-41). These are proven methods and appropriate to a project of this nature. Also used for continuous improvement opportunities will be an advisory board consisting of experts, all of whom are experts in GT and external to the project (pg. e42).

Weaknesses:

2. It was not clear how and when the timelines would be completed on Goal 3 during the 8th grade year. Better and more specific descriptions on screening processes are needed to determine extent of meeting goals (pg. e-29).

Reader's Score: 28

Selection Criteria - Quality of the Management Plan**1. (c) Quality of the Management Plan (up to 20 points).**

The Secretary considers the quality of the management plan for the proposed project. In determining the quality of the management plan for the proposed project, the Secretary

considers the following factors:

- (1) The adequacy of the management plan to achieve the objectives of the proposed project on-time and within budget, including clearly defined responsibilities, timelines, and milestones for accomplishing project tasks;**
- (2) The adequacy of procedures for ensuring feedback and continuous improvement in the operation of the proposed project; and**
- (3) The extent to which the time commitments of the project director and principal investigator and other key project personnel are appropriate and adequate to meet the objectives of the proposed project.**

Strengths:

1. Table 2 on pg. e42 provides goals and objectives, persons responsible for achieving the goals, and years activities will be conducted.
2. The project makes use of several assessment tasks or measures, such as collecting continuous data, that will be used to inform the project's development (pg. e38-41). An advisory board will meet annually with the project team and provide feedback as needed (pg. e42).

Weaknesses:

1. Missing from Table 2 on pg. e42 was the milestones for task completion.
3. Time commitments of proposed project personnel were not identified for the management plan to evaluate if the goals are achievable (p. e27).

Reader's Score: **16**

Selection Criteria - Quality of Project Services

1. (d) Quality of the Project Services (up to 30 points).

The Secretary considers the quality of the services to be provided by the proposed project.

(1) In determining the quality of the services to be provided by the proposed project, the Secretary considers the quality and sufficiency of strategies for ensuring equal access and treatment for eligible project participants who are members of groups that have traditionally been underrepresented based on race, color, national origin, gender, age, or disability.

(2) In addition, the Secretary considers the likely impact of the services to be provided by the proposed project on the intended recipients of those services.

Strengths:

1. The applicant identifies three major ways that the project promotes equal access. The first is positive psychology; the second is through universal screening of all students; and the third is through targeting affective development supports (pg. e43). These services are of high quality and sufficient in number.
2. The potential impact of the services on the intended recipients are substantial. The applicant details two major changes from implementation of this model: 1) an increase in traditionally underrepresented students for G/T services, and 2) improved self-acceptance, purpose, positive relationships, personal growth, and developmental autonomy – skills

that are beneficial and needed by today's students (pg. e43).

Weaknesses:

None noted

Reader's Score: 30

Selection Criteria - Quality of Personnel

1. (e) Quality of Personnel (up to 5 points).

The Secretary considers the quality of the personnel who will carry out the proposed project.

(1) In determining the quality of the project personnel, the Secretary considers the extent to which the applicant encourages applications for employment from persons who are members of groups that have traditionally been underrepresented based on race, color, national origin, gender, age, or disability.

(2) In addition, the Secretary considers the following factors--

(i) The qualifications, including relevant training and experience, of the project director or principal investigator; and

(ii) The qualifications, including relevant training and experience, of key project personnel.

Strengths:

2. The Project Director, Dr. Olenchak, is highly qualified with professional experiences and contributions and has served as President of the National Association for Gifted Children (NAGC). He also has over 100 publications to his credit, including an award-winning book on curriculum for G/T students (pg. e44-45).

The three co-directors, Dr. Desmet, Dr. Seward and Dr. Traynor, are all highly qualified by education, experience, and/or professional contributions for their roles in this project. Dr. Desmet has supported three federal grants; Dr. Seward has 17+ years in K-12 schools; and Dr. Traynor has expertise in evaluation and statistics and also served on three other federally funded studies (pg. e45).

Weaknesses:

1. While the applicant stated that Purdue University has a history of attracting faculty, no current data regarding employment from members of underrepresented groups was provided, even among existing grant personnel. It was stated on pg.e-44 that 120 countries were represented among the faculty and staff; however, the statement is broad and lacks specificity to the proposed project personnel. It was also not stated how applications would be encouraged from underrepresented groups.

Reader's Score: 4

Selection Criteria - Adequacy of Resources

1. (f) Adequacy of Resources (up to 10 points).

The Secretary considers the adequacy of resources for the proposed project. In determining the adequacy of resources for the proposed project, the Secretary considers one or more of the following factors:

- (1) The extent to which the budget is adequate to support the proposed project;
- (2) The extent to which the costs are reasonable in relation to the objectives, design, and potential significance of the proposed project; and
- (3) The extent to which the costs are reasonable in relation to the number of persons to be served and to the anticipated results and benefits.

Strengths:

1. The applicant has a proposed budget that was reviewed by two offices of Sponsored Programs (Purdue and Valdosta State) to ensure that costs were both appropriate and adequate for project completion (pg. e46). The budget of more than \$2.8 million for five years is more than adequate to support the project's goals and activities.
2. The costs are reasonable in relation to the objectives and potential significance of the proposed project. Specifically, the development and implementation of an innovative identification method takes specialized personnel, time, and expertise to achieve successful outcomes. The design of this project allows a strong probability of success (p. e46).
3. The costs are reasonable in relation to the number of educators and students served and the anticipated results. This project will serve 40 educators and at least 680 students in universal screenings (pg. e46). The full impact will undoubtedly extend beyond the grant years, as publications, presentations, and distributed project training models are planned.

Weaknesses:

A review of the budget indicates some high costs for travel to conferences. For example, sending six people to a conference versus sending a representative group would maximize the dollars spent for travel (p. e46).

Reader's Score: 9

Priority Questions

Competitive Preference Priority - Competitive Preference Priority 1

1. (1) **Competitive Preference Priority 1--Training Personnel in the Identification and Education of Gifted and Talented Students Who are Children with Disabilities. (up to 5 points)**

Projects that include providing training to personnel in schools served under the project to assist such personnel in identifying and educating gifted and talented students who are children with disabilities. Such training may include, but is not limited to, workshops or programs that teach effective instructional and communication techniques, classroom practices and culture, and other strategies that support the social, emotional, developmental and academic needs of gifted and talented students who are children with disabilities.

Strengths:

This project will train teachers, counselors and/or administrators to implement the five positive psychology components in phase 2 (pg. e23). Specifically, training will include modules to identify students for gifted education services (pg. e28) who have disabilities.

Weaknesses:

None noted

Reader's Score: 5

Competitive Preference Priority - Competitive Preference Priority 2

1. (2) **Competitive Preference Priority 2--Identification of, and Provision of Services to, Gifted and Talented Students Who are Children with Disabilities. (up to 5 points)**

Projects that include developing new information that assists schools in the identification of, and provision of services to, gifted and talented students who are children with disabilities who may not be identified through traditional assessment methods.

Strengths:

This project will provide gifted education services to students with disabilities who are overlooked in traditional identification procedures (Goal 3 of project --- pg. e29). The new approach will be labeled BEM-e. Upon implementation, BEM-e will be evaluated in order to inform procedures and materials development, as well as implementation by the trained educators.

Weaknesses:

None noted

Reader's Score: 5

Competitive Preference Priority - Competitive Preference Priority 3

1. (3) **Competitive Preference Priority 3--Promoting Equity in Student Access to Educational Resources and Opportunities. (up to 5 points)**

Projects designed to promote educational equity and adequacy in resources and opportunity for underserved students—

- (1) In one or more of the following educational settings:

- (i) Middle school.
- (ii) Elementary school.*
- (iii) High school.
- (iv) Career and technical education programs.
- (v) Out-of-school-time settings;

- (2) That examine the sources of inequity and inadequacy and implement responses, and that may include one or more of the following:

(i) Rigorous, engaging, and well-rounded (e.g., that include music and the arts) approaches to learning that are inclusive with regard to race, ethnicity, culture, language, and disability status and prepare students for college, career, and civic life, including one or more of the following:

(A) Student-centered learning models that may leverage technology to address learner variability (e.g., universal design for learning, K-12 competency-based education, project-based learning, or hybrid/blended learning) and provide high-quality learning content, applications, or tools.

(B) Middle school courses or projects that prepare students to participate in advanced coursework in high school.

- (C) Advanced courses and programs, including dual enrollment and early college programs.
- (D) Project-based and experiential learning, including service and work-based learning.
- (E) High-quality career and technical education courses, pathways, and industry-recognized credentials that are integrated into the curriculum.
- (F) Science, technology, engineering, and mathematics (STEM), including computer science coursework.

(ii) Increasing the number and proportion of experienced, fully certified, in-field, and effective educators, and educators from traditionally underrepresented backgrounds or the communities they serve, to ensure that underserved students have educators from those backgrounds and communities and are not taught at disproportionately higher rates by uncertified, out-of-field, and novice teachers compared to their peers.**

*Note: The Javits program supports gifted and talented programs and their students in elementary schools and secondary schools. In States in which elementary education includes preschool, preschool students may receive services through the Javits program.

**Note: All strategies to increase racial diversity of educators must comply with applicable law, including Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964.

Strengths:

The applicant will employ a new model and train 40 educators in middle schools. This approach will promote equity in student access for opportunities in Gifted and Talented program (pg. e26).

Weaknesses:

None noted.

Reader's Score: 5

Application Requirements - 4644(b) and (c) of the ESEA

1. (1) The proposed identification methods, as well as gifted and talented services, materials, and methods, can be adapted, if appropriate, for use by all students;

The only score that can be given is zero (0).

Met

Reader's Score: 0

2. (2) The proposed programs can be evaluated

The only score that can be given is zero (0).

Met

Reader's Score: 0

3. (3) The proposed project will provide for training of personnel in the identification and education of gifted and talented students and in the use, where appropriate, of gifted and talented services, materials, and methods for all students.

The only score that can be given is zero (0).

Met

Reader's Score: 0

Status: Submitted

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